

Tobias Treppmann

Designer who owns the full loop — writes the brief, designs the flow, prototypes it in code, ships it

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

EMAIL

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PORTFOLIO

treppmann.design/for/taxfix-ai-first-builder-design

LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years, and the work I do best is the work with no handoff in it — the brief, the flow, the prototype, the thing that actually ships. I prototype in real code against real APIs, and engineering builds production from it. The last year went into AI running in production rather than AI that demos, in a product where a wrong answer reaches a real person.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (B2C streaming product — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; under 1M users; engineering is external, product managers and product owners in-house, no other designers) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The whole loop, no handoff in the middle — I write the brief, design the flow, prototype it in real code against real APIs, and check the built feature in production.
- AI is how the loop closes — agentic engineering with Claude Code, introduced here as a design practice. engineering ships from that code.
- AI support copilot, live in production — drafts replies in the handbook's wording. A restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and every send decision stays human.
- AI fundraising system, built solo end to end — performance analysis, prompt architecture, an internal generation prototype, then a production Claude skill whose output ships across in-app notifications.
- The finish, built into the system — a color-extraction API and config tool of mine, live, driving image-based gradients that hold WCAG contrast in light and dark.

Head of Platform and Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview.
- Research at a scale a team cannot read — Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment, pain points and feature requests, with Dovetail as the shared repository.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — hired two, promoted two, let two go. Interim Head of Product from July to October 2023.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense interfaces where being wrong has consequences — big-data pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

Owning the Full Loop

Writing the brief · Designing the flow · Prototyping it in real code · Shipping it · Running the ticket board engineering works from · Customer calls and discovery as the main contact · Verifying the built feature in production and beta · Measurable outcomes, and the metric named: 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at ChurchDesk, engineering ships from that code

Building with AI

Both built without a playbook to follow or a platform team to inherit — the ambiguity was the starting condition

Prototyping and Engineering Proximity

Real-code prototypes against real APIs · Web, Android and iOS · Engineering adapting prototype code into production across a company boundary · HTML · CSS · TypeScript · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React · Reading the API spec

Craft, and the Part That Shows

Image-based gradients holding WCAG contrast in light and dark · Color-extraction API and config tool · Data-dense interfaces: pivot tables, filter logic, query-builder previews and sample-based uncertainty · Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Style Dictionary · Figma Variables · Multi-platform sync · Taste as an editorial layer: the visual standard is decided once, in the system, so it survives every screen after the first

Products Where Being Wrong Matters

Human-in-the-loop by design: the tool is embedded in nothing, so a person reads every letter before the model sees it, an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt, the send decision stays human · Analytics for top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers · GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law across six countries · EU accessibility compliance shipped

Consumer and Multi-Market

B2C streaming across iOS, Android, web and connected TV · Print-on-demand for hundreds of thousands of consumers at Spreadshirt · Behavioral design and habit formation · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · German native, English C2 · Berlin, CET